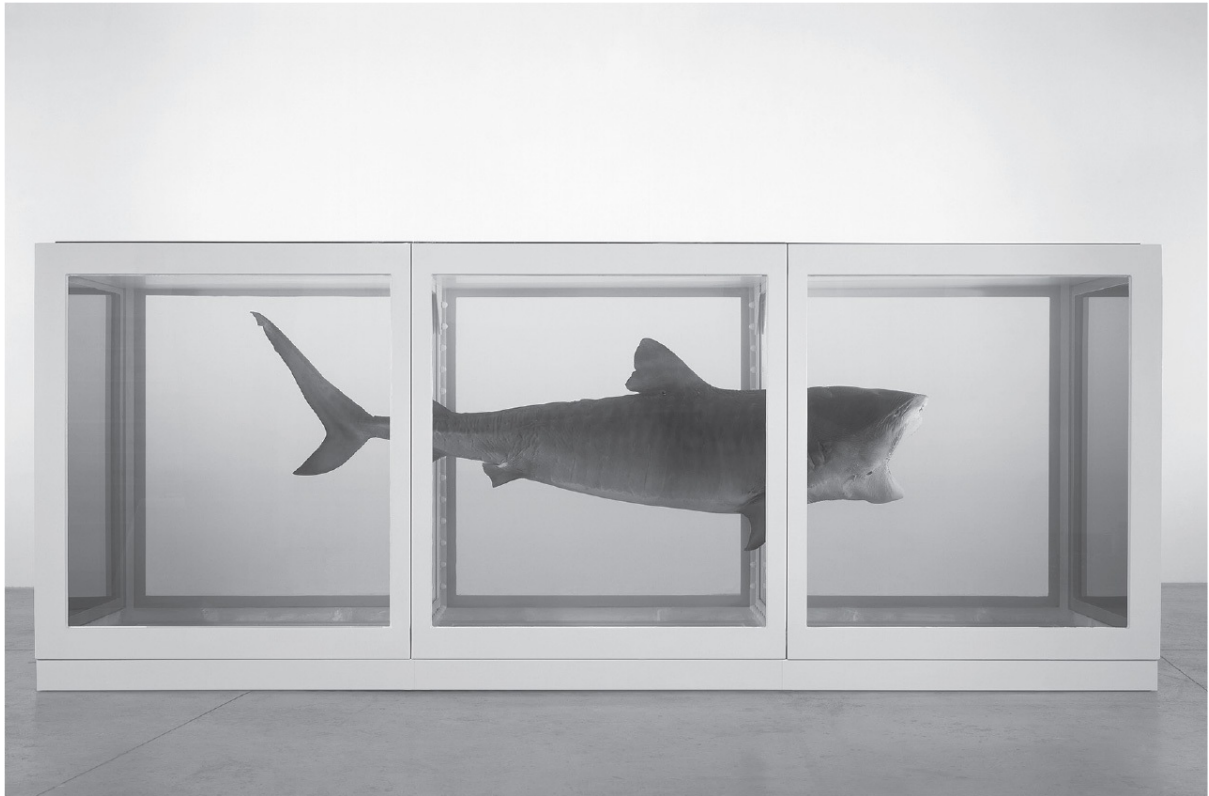


The YBAs

In 1997, a radical exhibition called 'Sensation' was held at London's Royal Academy. It included the work of artists including Damien Hirst (b.1965), Sarah Lucas (b.1962), Cornelia Parker (b.1956), Gary Hume (b.1962), Rachel Whiteread (b.1963), Marc Quinn (b.1964), Michael Landy (b.1963), Jake and Dinos Chapman (b.1966 and 1962 respectively) and Tracey Emin. Their collective nickname of the YBAs (Young British Artists) was more of a marketing term than an art movement, and deflected their diversity, but most shared an openness towards materials and processes, and many used installations, found objects, shock tactics and entrepreneurial attitudes.

Many of the group first exhibited in a 1988 show organized by Hirst and his contemporaries at Goldsmiths College of Art. Notoriously, the YBAs have preserved dead animals, crushed found objects, exhibited a dirty bed and made sculpture out of food, cigarettes and women's tights. But they have also made extensive use of film, video, photography, drawing, painting and printmaking.



Hirst, *The Physical Impossibility of Death in the Mind of Someone Living*, 1991